



DoView Tool H2 - Including Impact Information in Indicator Reporting Tool

When reporting indicator results, it is important to identify if you are just limiting yourself to reporting on controllable indicators (e.g. outputs) or also including not-necessarily controllable indicators (e.g. outcomes). The distinction between controllable indicators and not-necessarily controllable indicators is discussed in the DoView Planning Framework (D1). Just measuring not-necessarily controllable indicators does not prove that a particular initiative has improved them - they may have changed because of some other factor.

If an initiative is reporting on not-necessarily controllable indicators, any available impact information can be provided together with the indicator results (even if it is only informal information). Of course, it is important that providing this type of informal information is clearly distinguished from the results of formal impact evaluation studies, such as those described in the Seven Types of Impact Evaluation Designs Tool (G11). The example below is of an 'Archery Initiative' (a fictitious illustrative example of an initiative designed to fire arrows at a target (see B4)). Its indicator report below assumes, firstly, that there are barriers to hitting the bulls-eye out of the control of the Archery Initiative. Secondly, it assumes that other agencies may also be firing arrows in attempts to hit the bull's-eye. Controllable indicators are marked with an '@'. (See the Putting Indicators Onto a DoView Strategy/Outcomes Diagram Tool (D5) for more information on the indicators related to the Archery Initiative example).*

Controllable indicator	Level achieved	Target	Impact (informal information)
004 How many occasions bull's-eyes accurately identified @	94% of the time	90% of the time	There were two media articles quoting people who believed that the Archery Initiative was responsible for most of the arrows hitting the bull's-eye. Interviews with two people who know about the initiative's work said that they thought that the initiative was responsible for most of the arrows hitting the bull's-eye.
005 Number of arrows fired per hour @	104 per hour	100 per hour	
009 Number of arrows hitting the bull's-eye per hour	83 per hour	80 per hour (collaborative target)	

* See the Duignan et al (2003) Community Projects Indicator framework (CPIF) for a fully worked up example of using this approach.